



SAFETY CODE

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PURPOSE: To establish policies on SAFETY.

INTROUDUCTION:

It is the earnest desire of the cooperative to conduct its operation with the utmost regard on the safety of the employees, consumers, and the general public.

For this reason, it provides equipment specifications and working conditions designed to promote efficient operation, eliminate accidents and minimize hazards that may cause injuries.

To this end, the Board hereby adopts the following policies:

POLICIES on SAFETY RULES:

I. GENERAL RULES FOR ALL EMPLOYEES

1. APPLICATION AND RESPONSIBILITY
 - 1.1 Application of Safety Rules
 - 1.2 Employees' Responsibility for Safety
 - 1.3 Reporting Employees' Injuries
 - 1.4 Practical Jokes
2. GENERAL PRECAUTIONS
 - 2.1 Protecting the Public
 - 2.2 Taking Chances
 - 2.3 Reporting Hazardous Conditions
 - 2.4 Entering Hazardous Areas
 - 2.5 Guards
 - 2.6 Hold Cards and Tags
 - 2.7 Office and Clerical Works
 - 2.8 Warnings
3. PROTECTIVE DEVICES
 - 3.1 Eye Protection
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 - 3.3 Wearing Apparel
4. HAND AND POWER TOOLS
 - 4.1 Use of Tools
 - 4.2 Care of Tools
 - 4.3 General Precautions
5. PORTABLE LADDERS and SCAFFOLDS
 - 5.1 Straight Ladders
 - 5.2 Step Ladders



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- 5.3 Scaffolds
- 5.4 General Precautions

- 6. FIRE PREVENTIONS
 - 6.1 Fire Prevention-Housekeeping
 - 6.2 Fire Protection

- 7. OPERATION of MOTOR VEHICLES and OTHER MOBILE EQUIPMENT
 - 7.1 General Precautions
 - 7.2 Inspection
 - 7.3 Operations
 - 7.4 Loading and Hauling
 - 7.5 Accidents
 - 7.6 Aerial Baskets

II. ELECTRICAL DEPARTMENTS

- 1. ELECTRICAL EQUIPMENT and LINES
 - 1.1 Work on Energized Circuits and Apparatus
 - 1.2 Rubber Gloves
 - 1.3 Line Hose, Insulator, Hoods, Blankets, Line Guards, etc.
 - 1.4 Operation of Switches and Cut-outs
 - 1.5 Grounding de-Energized Circuits and Apparatus
 - 1.6 General Precautions
- 2. DISPATCHING AND CLEARANCES
 - 2.1 General Precautions
 - 2.2 Systems Under Dispatches
 - 2.3 System Not Under Dispatching
- 3. OVERHEAD LINES
 - 3.1 Body Belts and Safety Straps
 - 3.2 Climbers and Climbing Practices
 - 3.3 Poles-hauling and temporary storage
 - 3.4 Poles-setting and removing
 - 3.5 Rope and Hoisting Equipment
 - 3.6 Striving and Removing Wires
 - 3.7 Transformers and Capacitors
 - 3.8 General Precautions
- 4. USE and CARE of LIVE-LINE TOOLS
 - 4.1 Work Permitted
 - 4.2 Use of Tools
 - 4.3 Care of Tools

III. LINE CLEARING AND RIGHT-OF-WAY MAINTENANCE



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1. TREE TRIMMING
 - 1.1 General Precautions
 - 1.2 Tree Trimming Near Energized Conductors
 - 1.3 Tree Felling
 - 1.4 Care and Use of Tools
2. RIGHT-OF-WAY CLEARING and MAINTENANCE
 - 2.1 General Precautions

PART I – GENERAL RULES FOR ALL EMPLOYEES

SECTION 1. APPLICATIONS and RESPONSIBILITY

1.1 APPLICATION of SAFETY RULES

- a. POSSESSION – Upon assumption of duty, employees shall be given a copy of the Safety Rules. These Rules shall be kept on file while they are employed and returned when they resign or are terminated from the service.
- b. KNOWLEDGE - each EMPLOYEE shall study carefully these Safety Rules applying to his duties. Safety Rules shall be followed and ignorance shall not be an excuse for their violation; employees shall be periodically examined for their knowledge of the rules.
- c. INTERPRETATION – If an employee is called upon to perform work which he consider hazardous and not properly protected, he shall bring the matter to the attention of his supervisor before commencing work; if questions arise, interpretations rest finally with the supervisor.
- d. EMERGENCIES – These rules represent minimum requirements and are only intended to cover average conditions since it is impractical to cover all conditions and emergencies, the earnest cooperation of all employees with their supervisors is requested in meeting conditions not provided for in these rules.

1.2 EMPLOYEES' RESPONSIBILITY for SAFETY

- a. ABILITY – Before proceeding with a job, the employee shall see to it that he can perform the work without injury; if he is not qualified to perform, he shall call the attention of his supervisor.
- b. UNDERSTANDING – Before starting a job, each employee shall thoroughly understand the work to be done, his part in it and the safety rules that apply; TAILBOARD or pre-job discussion will promote safe operations.

1.3 REPORTING EMPLOYEES INJURIES



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- a. INJURIES, no matter how slight, shall be reported immediately to the person in-charge,
- b. All minor injuries shall be properly treated and a report be made of the employee's supervisor who shall observe or inquire about such injuries until they are healed; such injuries shall be reported in the Cooperative Employees Accident Form.
- c. When the service of a physician is necessary, the retainer physician of the Cooperative shall be utilized whenever possible.
- d. In cases of serious or fatal accidents, the injured employee shall be treated promptly.
- e. The accident shall be reported immediately to the department head and general manager.

1.4 PRACTICAL JOKES

- a. A practical joke and "horseplay" are strictly forbidden.

SECTION 2. GENERAL PRECAUTIONS

2.1 PROTECTING THE PUBLIC

- a. When an employee needs special, artificial light while working in customers premises, he shall use an electric flash light, electric lantern or suitable extension cords; a flame light shall not be used.
- b. The public shall be kept away from locations where work activity presents hazards.
- c. Pole holes, trenches, and obstructions shall be protected by suitable guards or covers, and where exposed to traffic, marked with DANGER signs during the day and lighted at night with red lantern, flares, or flashers so located as to be visible to traffic and the public.
- d. When it is necessary to warn traffic, flagmen or warning devices shall be necessarily stationed far enough to each side of the hazard to give vehicles enough time to stop.
- e. When necessary to leave reels, equipment, or other obstructions on a roadway overnight, the following shall be considered:
 1. They shall not be left adjacent to fire plugs or directly in front of entrances of parks, playgrounds, churches, houses, schools, etc.



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2. They shall be locked, blocked, or otherwise secured so that children or others cannot move them.
 3. They shall be adequately protected with approved warning devices.
- f. When chiseling, chipping, or welding is done in locations where others are exposed to eye hazards, shields shall be placed around the work, or the area roped off or barricaded.

2.2 TAKING CHANCES

- a. Before commencing any work that may be hazardous, care shall be taken to establish a safe procedure when more than one employee is engaged in the same job, all employees concerned shall understand the procedures to be followed; under no circumstance shall safety be sacrificed for speed.
- b. Employees shall see to it that they are always in a safe and secured position; the care exercised by others shall not be relied upon for protection.

2.3 REPORTING HAZARDOUS CONDITIONS

- a. When an employee observes a hazardous condition that may cause injury or property damage or interfere with services, regardless of their department in which such conditions exist, he shall report it promptly to the department involved.
- b. An employee who receives report of any hazardous emergency conditions shall obtain the informant's name and the exact location and the nature of the trouble. Appropriate steps shall be taken immediately to inspect or if necessary, to correct the condition.

2.4 ENTERING HAZARDOUS AREAS

- a. Only authorized employees shall enter restricted areas such as power plants, sub-stations, manholes, vaults, etc.
- b. Before entering manholes, vaults, tunnels, pits or other confined spaces, employees shall make sure that the enclosure is free from flammable or poisonous gases; if gas is suspected, an approved testing device shall be used.

2.5 GUARDS

- a. No guard shall be removed from the machine if it is in operation.



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- b. Machines and other tools shall not be operated with guards removed except where temporary protection is provided; if it is necessary, they shall be replaced by permanent guards as soon as possible.

2.6 HOLD CARDS AND TAGS

- a. Before starting work on any circuit, machines, belting, shafting, or other apparatus out of service, employees shall assure themselves that a standard HOLD card or tag is properly attached to the apparatus control.
- b. No switch, governor, valve, throttle, or other devices used to put the circuit or equipment into service shall be operated while a HOLD card or tag is attached.
- c. A HOLD card or tag that has been replaced for the protection of workers shall be removed upon the authorization of the person for whose name it was placed and only after the work has been completed and all workmen and tools are cleared from the equipment in service. (Follow operating instructions pertaining to the equipment.)
- d. Each man in charge of work on any equipment shall have his HOLD card or tag in the apparatus control.

2.7 OFFICE and CLERICAL WORK

- a. Chairs, wastebaskets, cuspidors, cords, and other articles shall not be left in aisles where they constitute a tripping hazard.
- b. Desk drawers, cabinet doors, slides, and files shall not be left standing open while unattended.
- c. Common or sharp-pointed pins are not to be used for fastening paper together; approved staples, clips, or other approved fasteners shall be used.
- d. Broken glass or rather sharp-edged objects shall be placed in wastebaskets unless properly protected.
- e. Approved type of ladders or other safe supports shall be used to reach materials on high shelves or other similar locations.

2.8 WARNINGS

WARNINGS signs shall be heeded:



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Persons seen in dangerous situations shall be warned without being startled; employees shall always keep themselves away from dangerous places where they are required.

SECTION 3. PROTECTIVE DEVICES

3.1 EYE PROTECTION

Eyeglasses (even with hardened lenses) are not substitute for goggles; full cover goggles and/or face shields shall be worn when an employee is engaged in or near the work involving:

- a. Drilling or chipping stone, brick, concrete, paint, pipe coatings or metal and the breaking of frozen grounds.
- b. Power grinding, buffing, or wire brushing whether there is a built-in eye shield or not..
- c. Dust or fling particles (such as using compressed air to clean materials or machinery).
- d. Flame welding, cutting or burning (approved colored lenses shall be used.)
- e. Drilling with hand or electric drill overhead.
- f. Flying particles caused by other workmen, if employee is within range of such particles (suitable screen around the work may be used instead.)

3.2 HEAD PROTECTION

- a. Approved safety head gear shall be worn by all employees in areas where falling objects, electrical contact, or other hazards may cause head injuries.

This rule applies to ALL supervisors or other observing the work as well as employees who are actually performing the work.

- b. Safety head gear or head band assembly shall not be defaced or altered in any manner without approval.

3.3 WEARING APPAREL

Each employee shall wear shoes, gloves, and other clothing suitable to the work to be performed; rubber glove protectors shall be used as work gloves. (rubber shoes or shoes with less than one-half inch thick heels shall not be used by linemen.)

NOTE: Other protective devices are provided by the cooperative to be used in various types of work: the use of these devices are covered by use of applicable to



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specific departments.

SECTION 4. HAND and POWER TOOLS

4.1 USE OF TOOLS

- a. Hammers with metal handles, screw drivers or knives with metal continuing through the end or sides of hand les shll not be used on or near energized electrical equipment.
- b. Metal measuring tapes, tapes having metal strands woven into the fabric, brass-bound rules, metal scales and gauges, wire or metal-bund hose, or rope with wire core shall not be used in working on or near energized electrical circuits or equipment.
- c. Chisels, drills, punches, ground rods and pipes shall be held with suitable holders or tongs (not with bare hands) wile being struck with sledge or by another employee.)
- d. Slims shall never be used to make a wrench fit.
- e. Wrenches with a prong or damaged jaws shall not be used.
- f. Pipes shall be used to extend a wrench handle for added leverage unless the wrench was designed for such use.
- g. When using a draw-knife, an employee shall not brace the work with his knee or other parts of his body.
- h. Practical jokes with compressed air are strictly forbidden; compressed air entering or blown against the body may result to serious injury or death.
- i. Compressed air shall NOT be used either to clean clothing while being worn or to blow dust or dirt off the hair.
- j. when using a screw driver or other tools, an employee shall place himself in such a position that he will avoid injury if the tool should slip.
- k. Tools shall be used only for the purpose for which they are designed.

4.2 CARE OF TOOLS

- a. All tools shall be of approved type. Maintained in first class condition and subject to inspection at any time. A supervisor has the responsibility to condemn tools.



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- b. Tools with sharp edges shall be stored and handled so that they will not be injured or cause injury or damage: they shall not be carried in clothing pockets.
- c. Tools such as chisels, punches, drills, etc. becoming mushroomed or cracked shall be dressed, repaired, or replaced before further use.
- d. When faces of hammers, sledges, etc. become chipped or rounded, they shall be repaired or replaced.
- e. Wood handles that are loose, cracked, or splintered shall be replaced: taping or lashing them with wire shall not be permitted.
- f. All cutting tools such as saws, wood chisels, drawknives, axes, etc. shall be kept in suitable guard unless special compartment are provided for their storage.

4.3 GENERAL PRECAUTIONS

- a. All files, rasps, and other tools which have sharp tips shall not be used without approved handles.
- b. Tools, except those normally carried on belts, that must be raised or lowered from one elevation to another shall be placed in approved tool buckets or firmly attached to handles.
- c. Tools shall not be thrown neither from place to place nor from one person to person under any circumstances.
- d. Tools shall never be placed unsecured on elevated places.
- e. When working on or above open gratings, a canvass or other suitable covering shall be used to cover the grating and to prevent tools or parts from dropping to a lower level; danger areas shall be barricaded or guarded by man.
- f. Portable electric tools (except those with self-contained power) such as electric drills, saws, etc. shall have their frames effectively grounded at all times when they are connected to protect user from shock.

SECTION 5. PORTABLE LADDERS AND SCAFFOLDS

5.1 STRAIGHT LADDERS

- a. Straight ladders shall not be used unless equipped with approved safety shoes; the distance from the foot of the ladder to the support it rests against should be equal to one-fourth (1/4) of the length of the ladder.



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- b. An employee shall not work or stand on either of the top two rungs of a ladder.
- c. Short ladders shall never be spliced together.
- d. A ladder shall never be replaced against an unsafe support.
- e. Ladder feet shall be placed on a substantial base.
- f. Ladders shall not be used as scaffold platform.

5.2 STEP LADDERS

- a. An employee shall not work from the top step of the ladder; this rule does not apply to safety flatworm ladders.
- b. While an employee is working on a step ladder (except a safety flatworm ladder) or at a point ten feet or more above the ground or floor, the ladder shall be held by at least one person.
- c. Step ladder legs shall be fully spread while ladder is in use.
- d. Step ladders shall be used as straight ladders; step ladders four feet and under may be used as straight ladders when equipped with safety feet.

5.3 SCAFFOLDS

- a. All scaffolds shall be of sufficient strength and rigidity to safely support the weight of men and materials to which they may be subjected.
- b. All scaffolds shall be equipped with railings and toe boards where practical.
- c. Scaffolds shall not be removed without first removing all loose tools, materials, and equipments resting on the scaffold deck.

5.4 GENERAL PRECAUTIONS

- a. An employee shall not use a ladder that has broken, loose, cracked rungs, side rails or braces.
- b. when ascending or descending ladders, employees shall have hands free, grip the sides, or rungs with both hands and face the ladder.
- c. Boxes, crates, chairs, etc. shall not be used to stand on while working.
- d. Only one employee shall work from a ladder (except hook ladders) at one time; if the work requires two employees, a second ladder shall be used.



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- e. If a ladder is to be placed where the opening of a door may displace it, the door shall be locked or otherwise guarded.
- f. Ladders shall be inspected frequently and repaired or replaced when found to be defective.
- g. Metal ladders or ladders with metal side rails shall not be used near energized equipment or lines.
- h. Ladders shall not be painted; they shall be treated only with transparent non-conducting materials.
- i. Only approved ladders owned by the cooperative shall be used by employees.

SECTION 6. FIRE PREVENTION

6.1 FIRE PREVENTION – HOUSEKEEPING

Good housekeeping shall be maintained at all work locations and in all vehicles.

- a. combustible materials, such as oil-soaked rags, waste and shavings shall be kept in approved metal containers with self-closing lids; containers shall be emptied as soon as practicable.
- b. Clean rags or wastes shall be kept in metal or metal-line bins with self-closing covers.
- c. No clothing shall be allowed to hang on walls, behind doors, or in space at the back of switchboards; no matches shall be left in clothes placed in lockers; rubbish and unused clothing shall not be allowed to accumulate in lockers.
- d. Paper and other combustible materials shall not be allowed to accumulate; weeds or other rank vegetations shall not be permitted to grow in or around the neighborhood or sub-stations, pole yards, buildings, oil tanks, or other structures.
- e. Flammable liquids such as gasoline, lacquer, thinner, etc. shall not be used for cleaning purposes unless approved methods are employed for their safe use.
- f. All solvents shall be kept in approved properly-labeled containers.
- g. Employees shall not smoke in proximity to flammable liquids, gases, or explosives, either on property occupied by the cooperative elsewhere.



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6.2 FIRE PROTECTION

Properly maintained fire fighting equipment is an essential part of good housekeeping; it shall be located in the most-accessible places and each employee shall be familiar with the operations of each piece of equipment so that fire may be promptly extinguished at an early stage.

All extinguishers shall be inspected, refilled, weighed, etc. in accordance with the Manufacturer's recommendation.

The date of such inspection, refill, etc. shall be recorded on tag attached to the extinguisher.

SECTION 7. OPERATION OF MOTOR VEHICLES AND OTHER MOBILE EQUIPMENT

7.1 GENERAL PRECAUTIONS

- a. Only authorized drivers who possess valid license or permits shall operate cooperative-owned vehicles.
- b. Drivers shall know and obey all traffic rules and regulations.
- c. A driver shall not permit unauthorized persons to drive or operate cooperative-owned vehicles.
- d. Seat belts shall be used in vehicles where they are provided.
- e. Drivers shall not permit anyone to ride on the running boards, fenders, or any part of the motorized equipment except on the seats or inside the body walls.
- f. Employees shall not ride on loose equipment or material carried by the truck.
- g. Employees shall not ride on trailers.
- h. Employees shall not jump on or off vehicles in motion.

7.2 INSPECTION

- a. Brakes shall be tested by the driver at the start of each day; drivers shall report any defect which may have developed during the day; if brakes are not working safely, they shall be adjusted or repaired before the vehicle is out on operation.



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- b. Lights and other signaling devices shall be inspected daily; if found defective, they shall be repaired before the vehicle is put in operation; no motor vehicle shall be operated at night unless equipped with proper working headlights, tail lights, and other necessary safety devices as required by law.

7.3 OPERATION

- a. The operator of a motor vehicle shall signal his intention of turning, passing, or stopping.
- b. Upon a signal from a vehicle approaching from the rear, the driver shall yield the right of way.
- c. Drivers shall be prepared to stop and the right-of-way yield in all distances when necessary to avoid accident
- d. Drivers following other vehicles shall provide a safe distance behind so that they can stop in the clear distance ahead.
- e. Trucks shall not be operated with tail gates hanging or dangling.
- f. A check shall be made to ensure that proper clearance is maintained between the antenna and energized equipment before radio-equipped trucks are driven adjacent to or beneath energized equipment such as outdoor sub-stations.
- g. Transmitters in trucks and cars shall not be used while the gasoline tanks of the vehicle is being filled.
- h. While refueling, all ignition system shall be turned-off and smoking shall not be allowed.
- i. Load limits of booms, derricks, and other hoisting equipment shall not be exceeded.

7.4 LAODING AND HAULING

- a. Materials and equipment shall be loaded in such a way that they will not cause hazards by shifting; heavy equipment and materials shall be securely fastened.
- b. Pipe, pike poles, ladders, etc. shall be located parallel with the truck length and carried as high as practicable.



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- c. Red flags during daytime and red lights during night time shall be attached to the materials or equipment to extend beyond the permanent fixtures provided on the side of the truck.
- d. Tools, materials, or equipment shall not be permitted to extend beyond the permanent fixtures provided on the sides of the truck.

7.5 ACCIDENTS

- a. Drivers of cooperative-owned vehicles shall always stop and give their names and addresses and the cooperative when involved in an accident; they shall also secure the names, addresses and license numbers of others involved in the accident, and the names and addresses of all available witnesses or others who may have knowledge of the accident.
- b. Drivers or other employees shall not determine or admit liability of the cooperative-owned vehicles not until proper investigation shall have been conducted when an accident occurs.
- c. All accidents shall be reported immediately in accordance with the cooperative's regulations.

7.6 AERIAL BASKET

The AERIAL BASKET is a piece of equipment which when properly used can eliminate or minimize many hazards in our daily work. Like any other piece of equipment, however, it has its inherent hazards. These hazards must be recognized and safe practices shall be followed to accomplish our main goal: THE PREVENTION OF ACCIDENTS DURING USE OF THE AERIAL BASKET EQUIPMENT.

- a. The operating and maintenance instruction manual issued by the manufacturer shall be followed.
- b. Load limits of the boom and basket shall not be exceeded; a warm-up period and test of the hydraulic system is essential.
- c. The truck shall not be moved unless the boom is lowered and the basket is cradled.
- d. Riding in the basket shall not be permitted while the truck is traveling between locations.
- e. Employees shall not belt to an adjacent pole or structure; employees shall always belt to the basket and belting to the basket equipment shall be done before it is moved.



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- f. In no case shall more than one conductor or phase be worked on at one time.
- g. When two linemen are working from the basket, extreme care shall be taken to avoid one man contracting poles, crossarms or other grounded or live equipments while the second lineman is working on energized equipment.

PART II – ELECTRICAL DEPARTMENTS

SECTION 1 – GENERAL

ELECTRICAL EQUIPMENT AND LINES SHALL ALWAYS BE CONSIDERED AS ENERGIZED UNLESS THEY ARE POSITIVELY PROVEN TO BE DE-ENERGIZED AND PROPERLY GROUNDED.

IF NOT GROUNDED, IT IS NOT YET DEAD!!

1.1 WORK ON ENERGIZED CIRCUITS AND APPARATUS

- a. Under no circumstance, except as provided in rules governing the use of live line tools, shall employees work on energized circuits or apparatus where the voltage between any two conductors is above 7,500 volts; all circuits and apparatus above this limit shall be de-energized and grounded before the work begins in accordance with Rule #5, Sec. 1, Part II of this Code.
- b. When working with rubber protective equipment on energized circuits or apparatus where the voltage between two conductors is between 7,500 and 15,000 volts, the following minimum conditions shall be met in addition to all other rules governing the use of protective equipment:
 - 1. Rubber gloves and rubber sleeves shall be used.
 - 2. Employees shall not make physical contact with protective devices installed on energized primary conductors other than their rubber gloves or rubber sleeves.
 - 3. Employees shall be isolated from all grounds (wooden poles shall be considered as grounds in this case) by using approved supplementary insulation such as aerial baskets or other approved devices.

1.2 RUBBER GLOVES

NOTE: Supervisors may require the use of rubber sleeves in addition to rubber gloves.



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- a. When rubber gloves work is performed on circuits above 5,000 volts, gloves rated at 20,000 volts shall be used.
- b. Rubber gloves and leather protectors shall be worn:
 1. While working on or within falling and/or reaching of any circuit which is or may become energized above 240 volts.
 2. While working on or within falling or reaching distance of any electrical equipment or metal surfaces such as crossarms, braces, transformer cases, etc. which are not effectively grounded and which may be or may become energized at any voltage during wet or stormy weather.
- c. When it is required, the rubber gloves shall be worn before the employee come to within falling or reaching distance (in any event not less than 5 feet) of unprotected energized circuits or apparatus or those which may become energized; they shall not be removed until the employee is entirely out of falling or reaching distance of such circuits or apparatus.
- d. In addition to the above energized circuits and apparatus, rubber gloves with leather protectors shall be worn when:
 1. Removing lead sheath and sleeves from cables and joints and opening or cutting cables, until they have been proven to be de-energized at the work location by positive test.
 2. Making stethoscope test on cables.
 3. Operating manually-controlled air break switches.
 4. Opening and closing manually operated oil circuit breakers.
 5. Opening, closing, removing or replacing hot line clamps, fuses, or fuse doors on circuits even when using an approved switch or hot line tools.
 6. Making tests to determine if lines are de-energized.
 7. Applying and removing grounding materials.
 8. Working on or near series street lighting circuits even though they are disconnected from the source of the power.
 9. Pulling in wires or handling other conducting materials near circuits, apparatus or equipment which is, or may become energized at voltages above 240 volts.



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- e. Rubber gloves shall be given air test and carefully inspected daily.
- f. When not in use, rubber gloves shall be kept in canvass bags or other approved containers and stored where they will not become damaged from sharp objects or exposed to direct sunlight; they shall neither be folded while stored nor objects be placed upon them.

1.3 LINE HOSE, INSULATOR HOODS, BLANKETS, LINE GUARDS, etc.

- a. Before work begins on or near energized circuits or apparatus, all live or grounded conductors and surface with which an employee can possibly come in contact (except that portion of the conductor on which work is to be done) shall be covered with approved protective equipment.

NOTE: Installing and removing protective equipment on circuits shall be considered working thereon.

- b. Secondary circuits, signal wires, multiple street lighting circuits, messenger cables, guy wires, etc. with which contact may be made while working on or near, or when climbing through energized circuits or apparatus, shall be covered with approved protective devices before workmen come within falling or reaching distance of the higher voltage circuits or apparatus.
- c. When necessary for employees to pass through or near circuits energized at line-to-line voltages between 15,000 to 45,000 volts in order to reach a working area above, or near the circuit to work on, the energized equipment shall be covered with approved protective devices placed in position with live line tools; circuits energized at voltages above 45,000 volts shall be tied out with live line tools if safe clearance cannot be maintained.

1.4 OPERATION OF SWITCHES AND CUTOUTS

- a. An employee shall not open or close any switch unless absolutely certain that it is the right one.
- b. Switches shall be left wide open or completely closed; the operator shall make a positive check that all blades and arching horns of gang-operated air break switches are in the desired position.
- c. Switches for interrupting load shall not be operated in a hesitant manner; they shall be closed by using sufficient force to make a full contact of blades with one movement and shall be opened with a quick, firm movement.
- d. Single pole disconnection switches, cut-outs, and hot clamps shall not be operated except with an approved switch stick or hot line tool.



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- e. A disconnection switch in series with an oil switch shall not be opened until the oil switch has been opened.
- f. When operating a cut-out, an employee shall position himself in such a way that he will be avoiding any injury whatsoever.

1.5 GROUNDING DE-ENERGIZED CIRCUITS AND APPARATUS

- a. When circuits and apparatus are de-energized for work, they shall be grounded and shorted with approved grounding devices on both sides of the location where the work is to be done regardless of whether there is more than one source of supply; under no circumstance shall work be done over one mile from the point of grounding.
- b. Before grounding devices are applied, an employee shall first determine by approved methods that the circuit or apparatus has been de-energized; the lowest or nearest conductor to the workmen shall be tested first; in case conductors of a circuit is broken, the approved test device shall be used on each side of the break before the grounding devices are applied.
- c. The grounding cable shall be connected to an effective ground before clamps are applied to the conductors.
- d. The clamps, stick and cable shall be raised to the working positions by means of a hand line, the workmen shall stand way below the circuit when applying the ground clamps; the conductor nearest the workman shall be grounded first, the nearest next, etc. until all phases have been grounded; the clamps shall be removed in the reverse order.

1.6 GENERAL PRECAUTIONS

- a. When working on one section of a sub-station or compartment adjacent to other sections or compartments where there are energized circuits or apparatus, the section or compartment being covered shall be conspicuously marked with ropes and/or barriers to designate the working areas.
- b. No employee shall touch any exposed lone, wire, or apparatus energized at less than 240 volts unless he is insulated from other conducting surfaces or he uses adequate protective devices.
- c. Secondary windings of current or series transformers shall be short-circuited before any instrument or other devices connected in the circuit is removed.
- d. Employees shall not carry metal articles on their shoulders near energized electrical equipment.



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- e. Potential transformers, when installed on line or apparatus to be worked on while being de-energized and there is possibility of backfeed, shall be disconnected from such lines or apparatus or their secondaries opened before commencing with the work.
- f. Jumper to connect dead conductors to live circuits shall be attached first to the dead part and then to the live one; they shall be removed in the reverse order.

SECTION 2 – DISPATCHING AND CLEARANCES

2.1 GENERAL PRECAUTIONS

- a. All oral communications about dispatching and clearances shall be recorded by the person receiving them and read back to the person giving them.
- b. Under no circumstance shall clearances be granted or released on a pre-determined time basis.
- c. When two or more crews are working on the same line or apparatus and are not under the supervision of one general foreman or other supervisor, each crew foreman shall request and release his own clearance independently in accordance with these rules.
- d. A HOLD card or tag shall be attached to each switch providing clearance on a cleared line or apparatus.
- e. The handles of switches providing clearances to work on lines or apparatus shall be blocked or closed in addition to being hold-carded or tagged.

2.2 SYSTEMS UNDER DISPATCHES

- a. Under no circumstances shall HOLD cards or tags be removed or the line or apparatus be in service until so ordered by the dispatcher.
- b. Before ordering any HOLD card or tag removed and lines or equipment returned to service, the load dispatcher shall require that the same man who received the clearance shall report that the line or equipment may be re-energized.

2.3 SYSTEMS NOT UNDER DISPATCHES

- a. When it is necessary to obtain a working clearance on any line or apparatus NOT under the jurisdiction of a dispatcher, the request shall be made directly to the person having jurisdiction.



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- b. After de-energizing the line or apparatus and attaching HOLD cards or tags to each switch providing clearance on the line or apparatus, the employee shall report back to the person making the request that the line or apparatus is out of service and that work shall be started after adequate grounds have been installed.
- c. A line or apparatus shall not be returned to service and the HOLD cards or tags be removed until the person concerned released his clearance.

EXEMPTION: If the person who received the clearance must leave the work before it is completed, he shall inform the person having jurisdiction by giving him the name of the person who takes his place.

In such cases, the person having jurisdiction shall communicate with both men, releasing the men who is leaving and accepting the authorized substitute.

- d. When the work is completed, wherein the grounds are removed and all the men are clear, the employee who received the clearance or his properly-authorized substitute shall report to the person having jurisdiction that the line or apparatus is ready for service.

SECTION 3. OVERHEAD LINES

3.1 BODY BELTS and SAFETY STRAPS

- a. Lineman's body belts and safety straps shall be of approved design and construction.
- b. Metal hooks, chains, etc. for holding tools or tape shall not be attached to body belts; leather or other non-conducting materials shall be used for this purpose.
- c. Belt bags shall not be attached closer than four (4) inches to "D" rings.
- e. Employees shall not carry tools in the center back loop of body belts; preferably, center back loops should be removed.
- f. When an employee reaches his working position aloft, he shall fasten his safety strap securely around the supporting structure.
- g. After the safety strap is snapped into place, the employee shall test it carefully by applying his weight against the safety strap to make it sure that it is properly fastened; this test shall be made each time the safety strap is used in a new position.



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- h. The safety strap shall not be put around a pole above the top crossarm position, except where pole top or attachment is above eye level; it shall not be used on pole steps, crossarms, braces, insulators, insulator pins, conductors, rotten or otherwise weak crossarms or an attachment which are being moved; when it is necessary to attach to a crossarm, the safety strap shall never be placed beyond the outside crossarm attachment; it shall be so placed that it will not be cut by line equipment or twisted or fouled by material which may give way under strain.

3.2 CLIMBERS and CLIMBING PRACTICES

- a. Climber spurs shall be kept properly sharpened and shall not be less than one-fourth (1/4) inches in length measured on the underside.
- b. Poles, except new poles, shall be thoroughly tested before they are climbed; if a pole is not strong enough to sustain lineman's weight by reason of its condition or its placement (such as soft earth), it shall be guyed or otherwise secured throughout the time any work is being performed; in order to support the pole while guys are placed, it shall be piked or otherwise secured; if pikes are used, they shall be repleted; if the pole to be climbed is being replaced and the new pole is set adjacent to it, the old pole may be lashed to the new one in lieu of guying.
- c. When two employees shall work on the same pole at the same time, one shall reach the working position before the other leaves the ground; they shall descend the pole one at a time.
- d. Employees shall not thrust their weight to guy wire, pins, braces, conductors, or other such equipment that might prove unstable.
- e. Pole climbers shall not be worn except when necessary for working on poles or pole structures.
- f. When climbers spurs are stored in the truck or tool room, they shall be placed wherein the sharp points will not damage other equipment or cause personal injury.

3.3 POLES – HAULING and TEMPORARY STORAGE

- a. The trailing end of a load of poles shall be marked by red flag during daytime and a red light at night time; as an additional precaution, warning flags or lights may be placed in the center of long loads; if necessary, an employee shall be utilized for flagging.
- b. If it becomes necessary to store poles at the location where they are to be set, they shall be so placed that they will not interfere with the traffic.



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- c. If the poles on or near streets, highways or walkways during night create hazard, they shall be safeguarded by red lights or well-lighted warning signal.
- d. Poles shall be so placed or blocked that they will not roll.
- e. Employees shall not stay in a pole pile while poles are being hoisted.
- f. Poles loaded on a truck or trailer shall be securely fastened in at least two places.
- g. When a load of poles is within working distance of the ground, loan binders shall be so installed that they can be operated by employees while standing on the ground.

3.4 POLES – SETTING and REMOVING

- a. If any holes are left unfilled at the end of the work period, they shall be protected with substantial coverings.
- b. All persons not engaged in pole-setting operations shall keep out of the work area.
- c. No one shall be allowed in a gin pole when it is being used to raise another pole.
- d. While setting or removing poles between or near conductors energized above 300 volts:
 - 1. The conductors shall be de-energized, covered with protective devices, spread, or a pole guard to minimize accidental contact.
 - 2. Workmen handling the butt of the pole shall wear rubber gloves whether or not cant hooks, peaveys, or slings are used.
 - 3. Until a pole is positively secured from against an energized conductor, no one shall step on or off the truck, or touch any part of it without using rubber gloves.
 - 4. Ground wires shall be attached to the pole higher than ten (10) feet from the ground.
- e. When pikes are used to hold poles in place while holes are being backfilled, the pike shall be firmly grounded in all directions and shall be removed until the backfill is sufficient to hold the pole; when a pole is being "canted" or "hooked", the pikes shall be held.



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3.5 ROPE HOISTING EQUIPMENT

- a. Handlines shall not be less than one-half (1/2) inch Manila rope or its equivalent.
- b. Handlines shall be carried up to the pole uncoiled with the end attached to the tool belt. They shall not be held in the hand while climbing.
- c. When camealongs are attached to blocks or hoists, the hooks shall be taped or moused unless snap hooks are used to prevent the camealongs from falling off.
- d. Metallic hoisting lines shall not be taken above the level of conductors energized in excess of 500 volts unless special precautions are taken.
- e. Metallic slings (chain or cable) shall not be used near energized equipment.

3.6 STRINGING AND REMOVING WIRES

- a. When pulling in or removing wires parallel to or crossing energized circuits or apparatus, such circuits or apparatus shall be deenergized and grounded if at all practicable. When such circuits and apparatus cannot be deenergized, suitable grounds shall be installed on the new conductor for protection against static or induced currents and against accidental contacts with energized circuits.
- b. When wire is being strung parallel to an energized circuit, extreme care shall be used to keep it from becoming fouled on trees, bushes, crossarms or other objects. If the wire becomes fouled, the pulling operation shall be stopped and the tension on the wire shall be relieved before any attempt is made to clear it.
- c. Wire being strung or removed shall be kept clear of sidewalks, driveways, alleys, streets, highways, and railway tracks at all times, if possible, watchmen shall be stationed to stop or reroute pedestrians and vehicles.
- d. Wires shall not be attached to or removed from a pole until it is certain that the pole shall withstand the altered strain.
- e. An employee when going aloft shall use handline to raise wires after reaching the working position on the pole or structure.

3.7 TRANSFORMERS AND CAPACITORS

- a. The primary leads of the distribution transformer shall be considered energized at full voltage not until both the primary and secondary leads have been disconnected or it has been definitely determined that the



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secondary circuit to which it is attached is not energized from other transformers.

- b. The cases of all transformers connected to a source of supply shall be considered as being energized at the full primary voltage unless they are adequately grounded.
- c. Employees shall not stand on or otherwise contact transformers while working on or near energized circuits.
- d. Capacitors shall not be worked on or the connections/terminals handled, until the fuses or disconnect switches have been opened and the terminals, shorted and grounded. After opening the fuses or disconnects, shorting jumpers and grounds shall be applied only after five (5) minutes. The shorting jumpers shall be applied with a hot stick.
- e. Employees shall not come in contact with an ungrounded capacitor case until the capacitor has been disconnected from the circuit and the terminals shorted.
- f. The terminals of used capacitors in storage shall be shorted.

3.8 GENERAL PRECAUTIONS

- a. Suitable line and tool bags shall be used for raising and lowering materials and tools. Employees shall not throw anything from a pole or structure to the ground or permit anything to be thrown to them while on a pole of structure.
- b. Rubber hose and hoods shall be raised and lowered in approved bags.
- c. In case of trouble following storms, all wires shall be considered as being energized at the highest voltage to which the lines are subjected. They shall be handled with appropriate protective equipment until properly grounded.
- d. The use of hand axes in overhead work is strictly prohibited.

SECTION 4. USE AND CARE OF LIVE-LINE TOOLS

4.1 WORK PERMITTED

- a. Lines of Numbers #6 copper, #6 ACSR, and #8A copperweld or smaller shall not be worked on with live-line tools except in specific instances where continuity or service is vital upon special authorization.
- b. Planned work with live-line tools shall not be started during unfavorable weather.



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4.2 USE OF TOOLS

- a. Before the start of the work using live-line maintenance tools, the dispatcher or person having jurisdiction shall be notified. If during live-line tool work an interruption to service occurs, the dispatcher or other person having jurisdiction shall be notified immediately.
- b. Only tools approved by the Cooperative shall be used in live-line maintenance work.
- c. A careful check shall be made to see that the condition of the structure and lines at the point of the work is such that the job may be performed safely. In addition, the adjacent spans and structures shall be carefully checked for defects in conductors, tie wires, insulators and other equipment.
- d. Under no circumstances shall a lineman depend on another workman to hold a live conductor clear of his.
- e. As tie wires are removed, they shall be rolled into a ball or cut off as they are unwound as soon as possible to prevent short circuit by reaching a ground or other conductor.
- f. During the installation or removal of a tie wire, a lineman shall steady the conductor on the insulator with a proper tool.
- g. When removing heavy conductors, blocks shall be used on the live-line tools so that they may be moved slowly and carefully.
- h. A workman shall not change his position on the pole or structure without first making certain that his new position will place him in the clear and shall inform his fellow workman what he intends to do.
- i. Employees shall not stand underneath lines being worked on unless they are actually assisting in the work.
- j. While live-line work is in progress, no other work of any nature shall be performed on the same pole or structure.
- k. Blocks and lines under strain shall be snubbed to permanent structures or temporary anchors. They shall never be snubbed to trucks, trailers or other objects to be moved.
- l. Knots of not less than two half hitches security shall be used in tying off various lines.



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- m. While working on the lower voltage lines where the insulators are short, extreme care shall be taken to avoid contracting the crossarm or insulator pin with the metallic end of the tool while it is in contact with the conductor.

4.3 CARE OF TOOLS

- a. All live-line tools, when not in use, shall be kept in canvass bags or weather proof boxes for that purpose, and such containers shall be stored in a dry and, if possible, in a warm place.
- b. Line-line tools shall never be laid directly on the ground or against sharp objects such as barb wire fences. Special tool holders or tarpaulins shall be used for this purpose.

PART III – LINE CLEARING AND RIGHT-OF-WAY MAINTENANCE

Section 1. TREE TRIMMING

1.1 GENERAL PRECAUTIONS

- a. When tree trimming, tree felling, brush loading or brush disposal operations are being undertaken on the street, highway or any other area accessible to the public, "Men Working" signs, cones, red flags or flares barricades and other warning devices (or combination thereof) shall be used to protect vehicular and pedestrian traffic.
- b. Climbers shall not be used in tree trimming work. (Except for certain types of palm trees.)
- c. Dead or rotten limbs, regardless of size, shall not be used by employees for support.
- d. Nom work shall be done in a tree until employee is securely tied in or belted to the tree.
- e. The safety line shall be crotched in a manner that will prevent its "working out" on a lateral limb.
- f. When working in a multiple-trunk tree, the safety line shall preferable be crotched around a main trunk besides the one on which the employee is working.
- g. The safety line shall not be used as a pull-rope or a handline to lower limbs or branches.



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- h. The ground end of a safety rope shall not be allowed to dangle over roadways and shall be kept free from obstruction, passing vehicles, etc.
- i. Branches or other materials shall not be dropped unless the immediate area has been cleared to prevent injury or damage to properties. If the possibility of injury or damage is apparent, a rope shall be used to lower branches or other materials.
- j. When lowering heavy tree members, employees shall not tie fall lines around hands or bodies.
- k. Employees shall not attempt to clear limbs or brush from under that side of tree where the climber is working.

1.2 TREE TRIMMING NEAR ENERGIZED CONDUCTORS

- a. Wires in proximity to tree trimming shall be considered as energized, unless proven to be dead and grounded.
- b. Employees shall not remove tree limbs or branches from above energized conductors while the other employees are working in trees below the conductors in the same span.
- c. Broken or fallen wires shall not be handled except by men experienced in such work.
- d. Tree limbs shall not be dropped on conductors.
- e. Dr ropes shall be used in trees through which energized conductor pass.
- f. When using aerial basket equipment, employee shall take care not to bring himself or the equipment in contact with energized lines.

1.3 TREE FELLING

- a. Trees to be felled shall be inspected for dead limbs which may break or for broken limbs lodged in trees, either of which may fall into the working area as the job progresses.
- b. No one shall be allowed to work in a tree located near a tree that is being felled if there is any danger that it might be struck by any part of the falling tree.
- c. All persons not engaged in the felling operation shall be kept clear of guide ropes and other rigging.



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- d. Clear warning shall be given to all employees in area where trees are to be felled or heavy tree members are to be dropped.
- e. Once the felling of a tree has been started, it shall be completed before leaving the job.
- f. When trees or heavy tree members are felled, all exposed walks, roadways and lawns shall be protected with a cribbling of branches to avoid property damage.

1.4 CARE AND USE OF TOOLS

- a. Ropes shall be inspected periodically. Damaged sections shall be cut out and destroyed or the rope be replaced.
- b. Ropes shall be kept away from fire, acids, oil chemicals and all sources of excessive heat.
- c. Dragging ropes over rough surfaces and sharp objects, such as rocks, shall be avoided. Ropes shall be stored separately from sharp edge cutting tools.
- d. The cutting edge of tools shall be suitable sheathed or guarded except while in actual use.
- e. When not in actual use, the trimmer's saw shall be returned to the scabbard.
- f. Axes shall not be used in trees or carried on the shoulder.
- g. Tools shall not be thrown into or dropped from a tree; they shall be raised or lowered by a suitable rope line.
- h. A pruner shall not be laid on a limb, in a crotch or hooked in a wire or ropes. It shall be hooked over a limb strong enough to hold its weight.
- i. Ladders shall not be removed from the base of the tree when not in use.

Section 2- RIGHT-OF-WAY CLEARING AND MAINTENANCE

2.1 GENERAL PRECAUTIONS

- a. When two or more men are cutting brush, they shall be separated by at least ten (10) feet.
- b. All tree and brush burning shall be done in such a manner as to prevent damage to nearby trees, crops, buildings, or other property; fire shall not



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be started if there is any doubt that they can be adequately and properly controlled.

- c. Trees and brush shall not be burned in proximity to overhead lines and trees.
- d. Fires shall be extinguished or otherwise safely contained before the employees leave the work site.
- e. When emerging from right-of-way prior to a road travel, employees shall check brakes and brake line.

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President

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Secretary

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